47TH ANNIVERSARY

THE BEST OF INDIA

INDIAN PLAYS



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THEATRE OF THE SUBLIME

First a theatre of the roots, then a series of modernist subversions. The best of Indian theatre is, at its heart, a search for universals



(Scenes from)

1. ***Andha Yug*** *(Dharamveer Bharati, 1954)*

2. ***Ashadh Ka Ek Din*** *(Mohan Rakesh, 1958)*

It's a truly difficult task to choose the 10 best Indian plays from 75 years of India's independence. But since an attempt had to be made, I have tried to follow a certain logic. The following works, originally composed in one language, have all been translated and performed in various others over the years. That, I believe, should give us a reasonably reliable barometer of a play's success in communicating its thematic and dramaturgical universals—as long as we keep other essential criteria too in mind. Thus, if one were to compile a list of the most frequently performed Indian plays, these would certainly reign as the 10 most prominent among them.

We cannot even embark on this journey without mentioning Dharamveer